

AMANI AFRICA

"Amani" — Swahili for peace

De-escalating nationality-based violence before it starts.

OSF × Andela Hackathon | Stability & Social Cohesion + Safety, Reporting & Protection tracks

Andela Talent Network / Learning Community submission





THE PROBLEM

Rumors escalate faster than the truth

- Unverified claims about a nationality or community spread on WhatsApp and social media faster than any official channel
- By the time a crowd forms, it's too late to correct the record
- This is the pattern behind incidents like tension between Kenyan and Burundian communities, and attacks on Kenyan, Ghanaian, and other African traders' businesses in South Africa
- No fast way today for someone to check a claim, report a concern confidentially, or get help before it escalates

RUMOR

Reaches 1,000 people in minutes

VERIFIED FACT

Takes hours to catch up, if it ever does

The gap between the two is where violence happens.



WHO IT'S FOR

Two roles, one trusted loop



Community Members

Residents, traders, and business owners of any nationality.

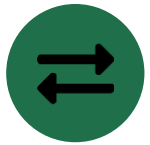
- Check if an area is calm before traveling
- Report a concern confidentially
- Request a protection contact if at risk



Verifiers

A small, trusted, and deliberately cross-community group — a local leader, a representative of the affected community, and a neutral party such as an NGO or faith leader.

- Confirm or debunk specific claims
- Set an area's tension level
- Never a single-community panel



HOW IT WORKS

One data source, two views, real time



Report submitted

optionally with photo or video



Verifier reviews

cross-community check



Fact-check posted

True / False / Unverified + why



Area status updates

live, for everyone



Same backend powers both a web app and a real WhatsApp number, via Twilio.



SEE IT LIVE

The core loop



Verifier Console

Live map — Green / Amber / Red

Incoming confidential reports

Fact-check + protection queue



instant sync



Community Assistant

WhatsApp-style chat

Quick replies, minimal typing

Live area status

A report made in one view appears instantly in the other.



SAFETY BY DESIGN

Built so it can't be weaponized



No identity registry

Nationality or vulnerable-group membership is never logged or listed anywhere.



Anonymous by default

Reporter contact info is optional and never shown publicly.



Verifier-only escalation

Tension level changes only by verifier action — never automatically from raw report volume.



Cross-community verifiers

Prevents capture by the same narrative the tool exists to counter.



TECHNOLOGY & AI USAGE

Built with AI-assisted development, real integrations



Claude API

Free-text intent classification (safety check / report / protection request / fact-check / status) and Swahili translation.



Keyword fallback

The app never breaks without an API key — a deliberate reliability choice for a judged, timed demo.



Real WhatsApp integration

Via Twilio — not a mockup. The same bot logic powers both the web simulator and the real number.



Built with Claude Code

Node/Express backend, Leaflet/OpenStreetMap live map, vanilla JS frontend — developed collaboratively end to end.



SCALABILITY

Built to extend, not to stay Kenya-only

2

Countries demoed

6

Areas modeled

4

Escalation safeguards

How it grows

- Area data is fully configurable — demo already spans Nairobi, Kisumu, Pretoria, and Durban
- The language layer extends the same way Swahili was added, for any language Claude supports

Roadmap

- SMS fallback for people without WhatsApp/data access
- Persistent database + authenticated verifier accounts
- Rate-limiting / anomaly detection on report floods
- Passive detection from public social and news mentions



WHY THIS LASTS

Built to outlast one news cycle



Reusable, not one-off

Once an area calms down, the deployment keeps running quietly in Green mode, ready for the next flare-up. A new hotspot is a config change, not a rebuild.



Built to last

Ushahidi pioneered crowd-mapping from Kenya's 2007 election violence, and its own research flags sustained unpaid moderation as the long-term strain. Amani Africa deliberately avoids that shape - a small, named, cross-community verifier role inside an existing peace-committee mandate, not a volunteer corps built from scratch.



Beyond one region

The same rumor-driven tension pattern shows up in DRC intercommunal disputes and elsewhere. Scoped honestly: built for pre-escalation tension, not for operating inside active armed conflict.

WORTH DEVELOPING FURTHER

What's next



Persistent database (Postgres) instead of in-memory storage



Authenticated, enforced cross-community verifier accounts



Passive rumor detection from public social and news sources

"Information people can trust, before rumor becomes violence."



github.com/peetlucas/amani-africa

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